

# SENATE . . . . . No. 2210

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## The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

***Rebecca L. Rausch***

*To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:*

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act extending the public records law to the Governor and the Legislature.

PETITION OF:

| NAME:                    | DISTRICT/ADDRESS:                       |                  |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------|------------------|
| <i>Rebecca L. Rausch</i> | <i>Norfolk, Worcester and Middlesex</i> |                  |
| <i>John F. Keenan</i>    | <i>Norfolk and Plymouth</i>             | <i>1/28/2025</i> |
| <i>Mike Connolly</i>     | <i>26th Middlesex</i>                   | <i>1/31/2025</i> |

# SENATE . . . . . No. 2210

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By Ms. Rausch, a petition (accompanied by bill, Senate, No. 2210) of Rebecca L. Rausch, John F. Keenan and Mike Connolly for legislation to extend the public records law to the Governor and the Legislature. State Administration and Regulatory Oversight.

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[SIMILAR MATTER FILED IN PREVIOUS SESSION  
SEE SENATE, NO. 2064 OF 2023-2024.]

## The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

\_\_\_\_\_  
In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court  
(2025-2026)  
\_\_\_\_\_

An Act extending the public records law to the Governor and the Legislature.

*Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:*

1           SECTION 1. Section 7 of chapter 4 of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2022  
2   Official Edition, is hereby amended by inserting, in line 168, after the words “chapter 32” the  
3   following words:- , or by the general court, or by the office of the governor of the  
4   commonwealth.

5           SECTION 2. Said section 7 of chapter 4, as so appearing, is hereby further amended in  
6   paragraph twenty-sixth by inserting the following new subparagraphs:

7           (v) communications between a member of the general court, or such member’s employee,  
8   agent, or representative, and any constituent of such member; provided, however, that the  
9   communications reasonably relate to a constituent’s request for assistance in obtaining

government-provided benefits or services or otherwise interacting with a state or federal agency;  
or

(w) communications, memoranda, drafts or other documents relating to developing policy positions of members of the general court or the governor of the commonwealth.

SECTION 3. Section 1A of chapter 66 of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2022 Official Edition, is hereby amended by striking out the words “agencies and municipalities”, in each instance, and inserting in place thereof the following words:- agencies, municipalities, the general court, and the governor.

SECTION 4. Said section 1A of chapter 66, as so appearing, is hereby further amended by striking out the words “agency or municipality” in lines 5-6 and inserting in place thereof the following words:- agency, municipality, the general court, or the governor.

SECTION 5. Section 6A of said chapter 66, as so appearing, is hereby amended by striking out the words “agency and municipality”, in each instance, and inserting in place thereof the following words:- agency, municipality, the general court, and the governor.

SECTION 6. Section 10 of said chapter 66, as so appearing, is hereby amended by striking out the words “agency or municipality”, in each instance, and inserting in place thereof the following words:- agency, municipality, the general court, or the governor.

SECTION 7. Said section 10 of chapter 66, as so appearing, is hereby further amended by striking out the words “agency or municipality”, in each instance, and inserting in place thereof the following words:- agency, municipality, the general court, or the governor.

30           SECTION 8. Said chapter 66, as so appearing, is hereby amended by striking out section  
31 18 and inserting in place thereof the following section:

32           Section 18. Declarations, affidavits and other papers filed by claimants in the office of  
33 the secretary of veterans' services, or records kept by him for reference by the officials of his  
34 office, shall not be public records.

35           SECTION 9. This act shall take effect on January 1, 2026.